

ILLUSTRATED WALKTHROUGH

Using the Terminal

Every command, shown as a picture, with what comes back.

First: you never open the client secret file

If you have been looking for how to open it, that is why nothing has made sense. There is no such step.

The file Google gave you is read by the **software**, not by you. You move it into a folder, and that is the last time you think about it. You never open it, never read it, never copy anything out of it, and never send it to anyone — including me.

Nothing is missing. Move the file, and you are done with it.

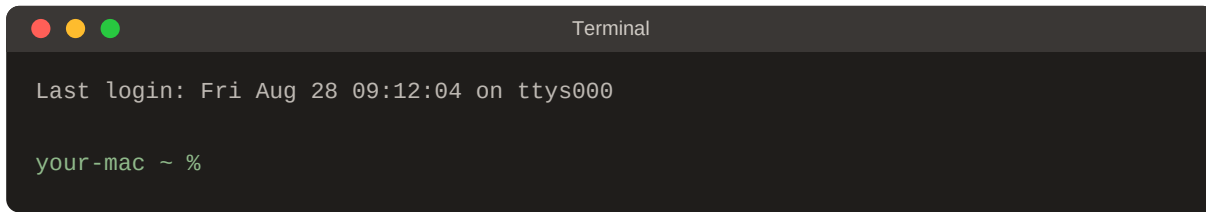
What this document covers

Opening the Terminal, understanding what you are looking at, getting to the right folder, and the three commands that move that file. Nothing else.

The pictures are drawings, not screenshots — but every line of text inside them is real, captured by running the commands. Your window may use different colours. The words will match.

What you are looking at

Open the Terminal first: press **Command** and **Space** together, type **terminal**, press **Return**. A window like this appears.



→ You type here. The text before it is not yours — leave it alone.

The three parts of every line

Part	What it is
your-mac ~ %	The prompt . The computer printing "ready". It is already there — you never type it. Yours will show your own Mac's name, and may end in % or \$. Either is fine.
What you type	Goes after the prompt. Nothing happens until you press Return .
What comes back	Printed underneath, starting at the left edge with no prompt in front of it.

The most important thing in this document

Most commands print nothing when they work. No message, no confirmation, just a fresh prompt on the next line.

That feels wrong — it looks like nothing happened. It is the opposite: silence is success. The terminal only speaks up when something went wrong. If you see a new prompt and no red text, it worked.

Two habits worth having

Copy and paste	You do not have to type these by hand. Copy from this document, click in the Terminal window, press Command + V , press Return . Fewer typos.
Press the up arrow	Brings back the last command you ran, so you can fix one character instead of retyping the line.

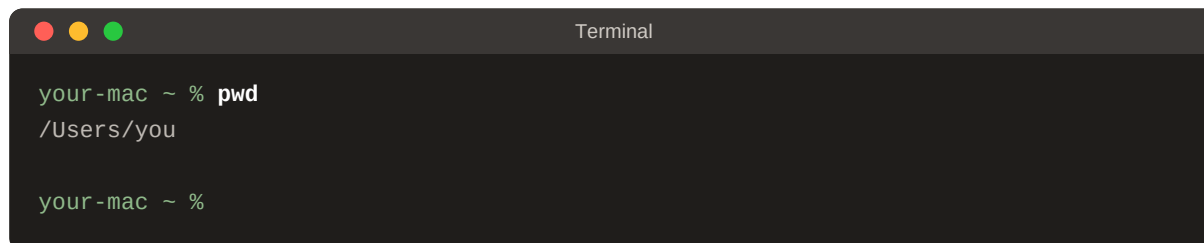
Getting to the right folder

The Terminal is always "in" one folder at a time, and commands act on wherever it is. Most confusion comes from being in the wrong one.

1

Ask where you are

Type this and press Return:

A screenshot of a macOS Terminal window. The title bar says "Terminal". The prompt is "your-mac ~ %". The user has typed "pwd" and the output is "/Users/you". The prompt is now "your-mac ~ %".

```
your-mac ~ % pwd
/Users/you

your-mac ~ %
```

pwd means "print working directory" — where am I. When you first open the Terminal you are in your home folder, shown as /Users/you (with your own name in place of you).

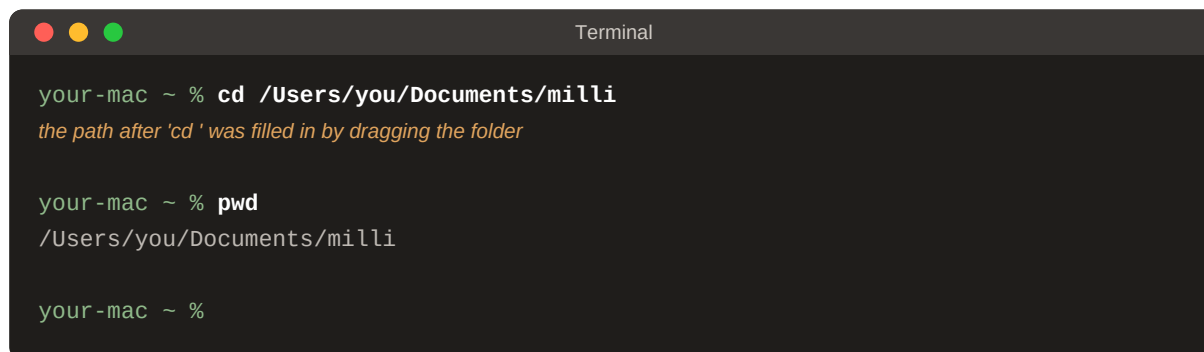
2

Go to the project folder — the easy way

Rather than typing a long path and mistyping it, let the Mac fill it in for you:

- In the Terminal, type cd then a **space**. Do not press Return yet.
- Open **Finder** and find your **milli** project folder.
- Drag that folder** from Finder onto the Terminal window and let go.
- The full path appears by itself. Now press **Return**.

It will look something like this:

A screenshot of a macOS Terminal window. The title bar says "Terminal". The prompt is "your-mac ~ %". The user has typed "cd /Users/you/Documents/milli". Below the command, a comment in orange italicized text says "the path after 'cd ' was filled in by dragging the folder". The prompt is now "your-mac ~ %". The user has typed "pwd" and the output is "/Users/you/Documents/milli". The prompt is now "your-mac ~ %".

```
your-mac ~ % cd /Users/you/Documents/milli
the path after 'cd ' was filled in by dragging the folder

your-mac ~ % pwd
/Users/you/Documents/milli

your-mac ~ %
```

cd means "change directory" — go to this folder. Running pwd again confirms you arrived.

If it says "No such file or directory"

The path was wrong — usually a typo, or the folder is somewhere other than you thought. Do not try variations. Use the drag trick above; it cannot produce a wrong path.

Moving the credentials file

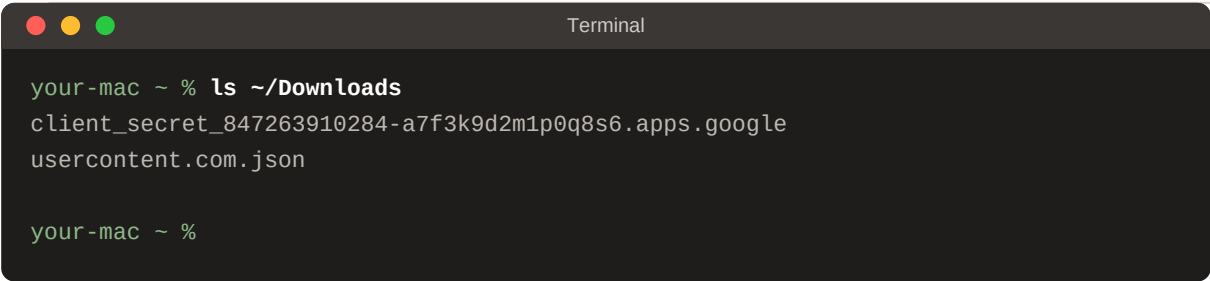
Three commands. The first two print nothing, and that is correct. The third is the one that shows you it worked.

Before you start

The file should be in your Downloads folder, with a long name beginning `client_secret`. If you are not sure it downloaded, step 0 below checks.

0

Check the file is actually there



```
your-mac ~ % ls ~/Downloads
client_secret_847263910284-a7f3k9d2m1p0q8s6.apps.google
usercontent.com.json

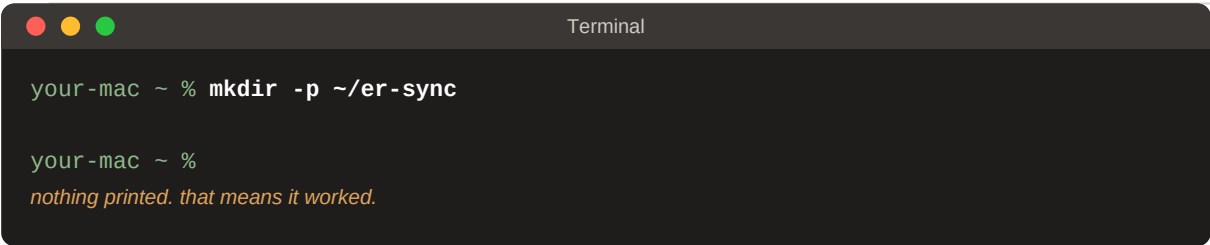
your-mac ~ %
```

`ls` means "list" — show me what is in this folder. The `~` is shorthand for your home folder, so `~/Downloads` is your Downloads folder wherever you happen to be standing.

You will see everything else in Downloads too. You are only looking for the one starting `client_secret`. It is long and it wraps onto two lines — that is one filename, not two.

1

Make the folder it will live in



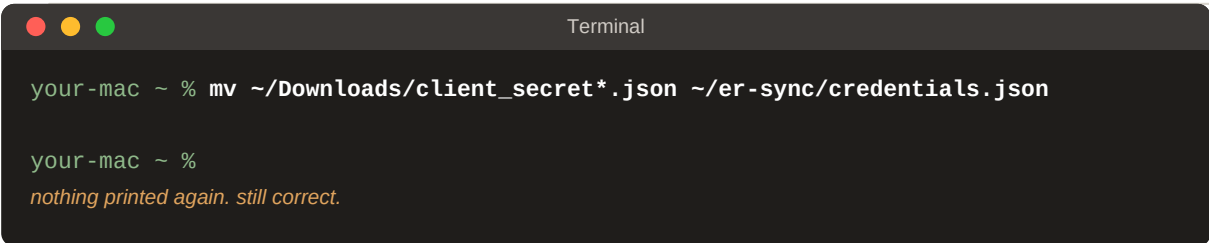
```
your-mac ~ % mkdir -p ~/er-sync

your-mac ~ %
nothing printed. that means it worked.
```

`mkdir` means "make directory". The `-p` tells it not to complain if the folder already exists, so this is safe to run twice.

2

Move and rename the file, in one go



```
your-mac ~ % mv ~/Downloads/client_secret*.json ~/er-sync/credentials.json

your-mac ~ %
nothing printed again. still correct.
```

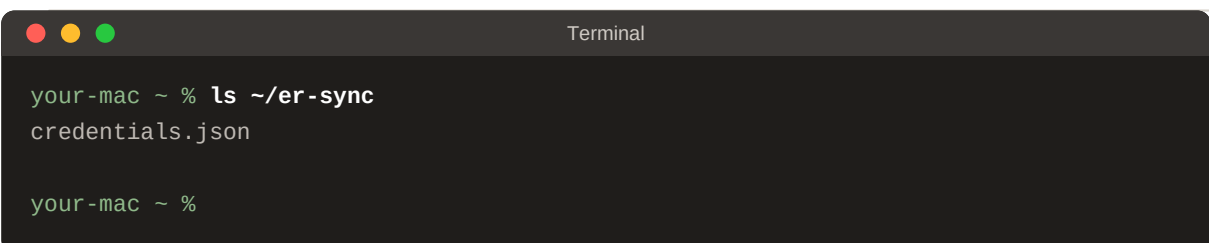
`mv` means "move". It takes the file from the first place and puts it in the second — and because the second ends in a new name, it renames it at the same time.

Why the star

`client_secret*.json` means "anything that starts with `client_secret` and ends with `.json`". The `*` saves you typing that long jumble of numbers exactly. You never type the real name.

3

Confirm it arrived



```
your-mac ~ % ls ~/er-sync
credentials.json

your-mac ~ %
```

This is the whole test. If it prints `credentials.json`, you are finished with this file forever. Do not open it. Do not look inside it. The software reads it from here when it needs to.

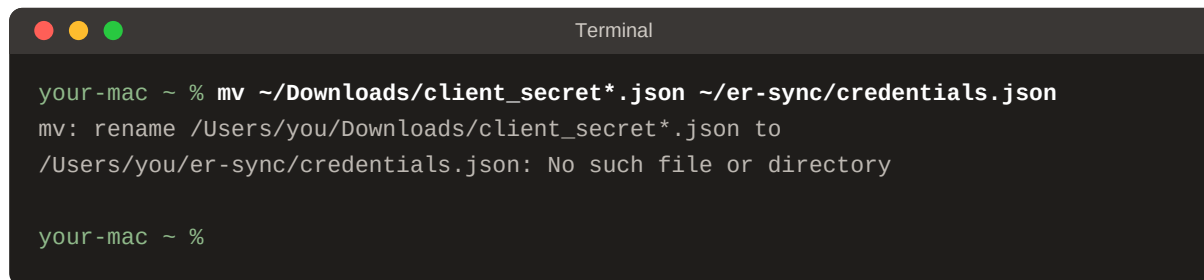
What if I already opened it, out of curiosity?

No harm done — opening a file does not change it. Close it without saving and carry on. The only thing that matters is that you do not send its contents to anyone, and that it stays in `~/er-sync`.

When a command complains

Three messages you might see, what each means, and what to do. Every one of these is recoverable.

"No such file or directory"

A terminal window titled "Terminal" on a Mac. The prompt is "your-mac ~ %". The user enters the command "mv ~/Downloads/client_secret*.json ~/er-sync/credentials.json". The terminal output shows "mv: rename /Users/you/Downloads/client_secret*.json to /Users/you/er-sync/credentials.json: No such file or directory". The prompt returns to "your-mac ~ %".

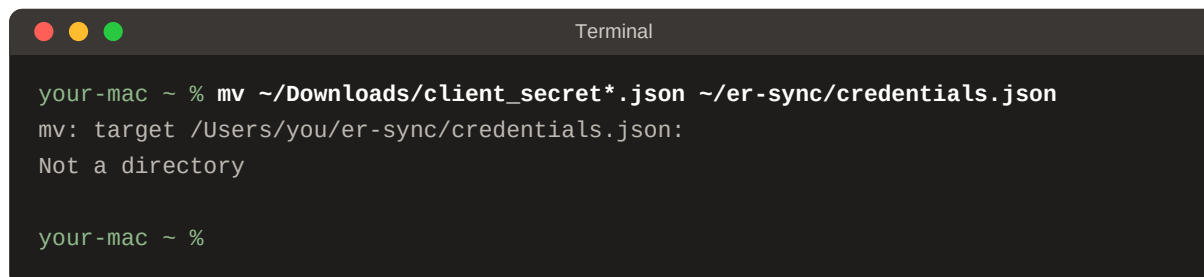
```
your-mac ~ % mv ~/Downloads/client_secret*.json ~/er-sync/credentials.json
mv: rename /Users/you/Downloads/client_secret*.json to
/Users/you/er-sync/credentials.json: No such file or directory

your-mac ~ %
```

Nothing starting with `client_secret` is in Downloads. Either the download did not happen, or Chrome saved it somewhere else.

What to do: run `ls ~/Downloads` and look. If the file is not there, download it again from the Google Cloud Console — Credentials, find your client, press the download icon on its row. You can download it as many times as you like.

"Not a directory"

A terminal window titled "Terminal" on a Mac. The prompt is "your-mac ~ %". The user enters the command "mv ~/Downloads/client_secret*.json ~/er-sync/credentials.json". The terminal output shows "mv: target /Users/you/er-sync/credentials.json: Not a directory". The prompt returns to "your-mac ~ %".

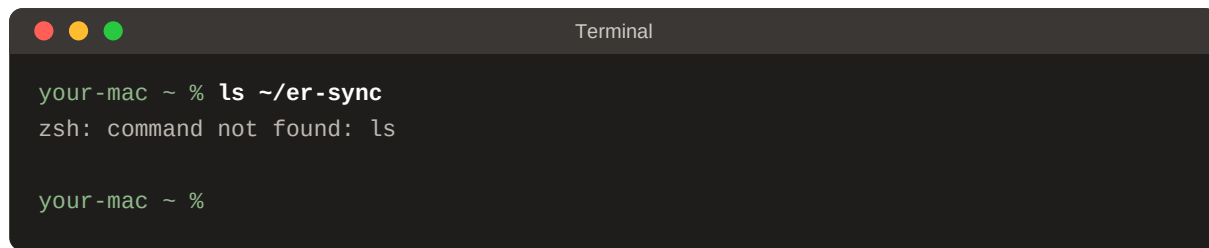
```
your-mac ~ % mv ~/Downloads/client_secret*.json ~/er-sync/credentials.json
mv: target /Users/you/er-sync/credentials.json:
Not a directory

your-mac ~ %
```

This one sounds like nonsense and has a simple cause: **you downloaded the file more than once**. The `*` now matches several files, and several files cannot all become one file.

What to do: open your Downloads folder in Finder, delete every `client_secret` file except the newest, then run the command again.

"command not found"

A screenshot of a macOS Terminal window. The title bar says "Terminal". The prompt is "your-mac ~ %". The user has entered "ls ~/er-sync". The terminal responds with "zsh: command not found: ls". The prompt is now "your-mac ~ %".

```
your-mac ~ % ls ~/er-sync
zsh: command not found: ls

your-mac ~ %
```

Almost always a typo, or a stray character pasted in with the command. Check the spelling and that there is nothing extra at the start of the line.

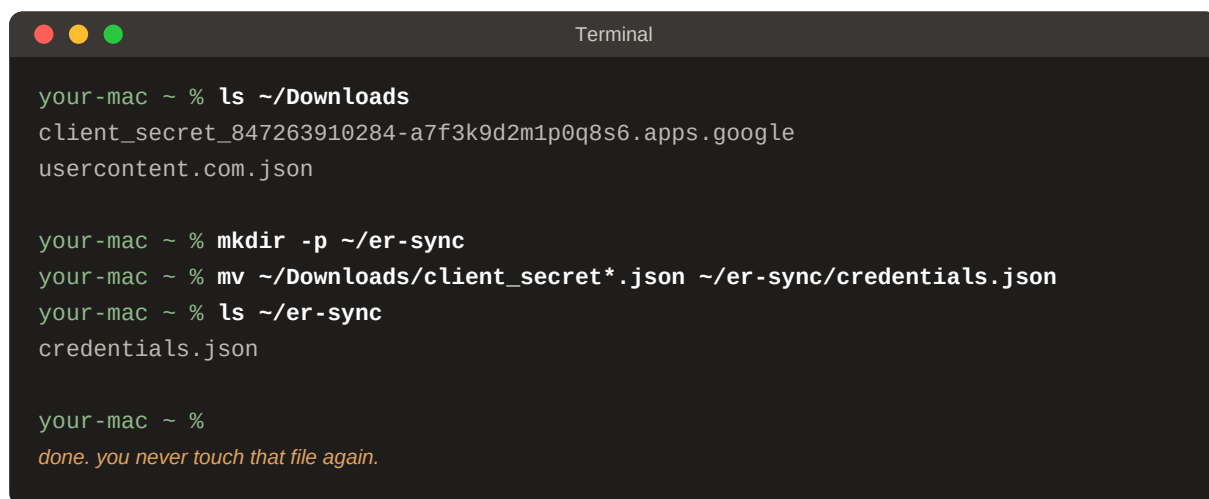
The safe reset

If you are lost, none of these commands has broken anything. `ls` and `pwd` only look; `mkdir` only adds a folder. Close the Terminal window, open a new one, and start again from `pwd`.

The one command that changes anything is `mv`, and the worst it can do is put the file somewhere unexpected. Nothing is lost.

The whole sequence, together

For when you just want the four lines:

A screenshot of a macOS Terminal window. The title bar says "Terminal". The prompt is "your-mac ~ %". The user enters four commands: "ls ~/Downloads", "mkdir -p ~/er-sync", "mv ~/Downloads/client_secret*.json ~/er-sync/credentials.json", and "ls ~/er-sync". The terminal outputs the results of each command. The prompt is now "your-mac ~ %".

```
your-mac ~ % ls ~/Downloads
client_secret_847263910284-a7f3k9d2m1p0q8s6.apps.googleusercontent.com.json

your-mac ~ % mkdir -p ~/er-sync
your-mac ~ % mv ~/Downloads/client_secret*.json ~/er-sync/credentials.json
your-mac ~ % ls ~/er-sync
credentials.json

your-mac ~ %
```

Still stuck?

Take a photo or a screenshot of the Terminal window, exactly as it is, and send it to me. The text of the error is enough for me to tell you the next command. There is nothing sensitive in an error message — but if the window happens to show anything from ExtendedReach, leave that part out.